

IT Services & Information Security Policy

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This policy covers company devices, accounts, remote access, the IT service desk, equipment during internal transfers, lost devices, exit, and the use of data and AI tools.

1. Purpose and Scope

- 1.1 This policy applies to all employees, contract staff and interns, and to every company device, account and system.
- 1.2 Breaking this policy may lead to loss of access and disciplinary action.

2. Devices

- 2.1 Every employee receives a standard company laptop on the first working day, provided HR has submitted the request as per Section 3.1.
- 2.2 Laptops are refreshed every 4 years, or earlier if found faulty by the service desk.
- 2.3 Personal devices may access company email and chat only after enrolling in the Mobile Device Management (MDM) app. No other company system may be accessed from a personal device.
- 2.4 Peripherals such as monitors, docking stations and keyboards are office assets assigned to a desk location.

3. Accounts and Access

- 3.1 New joiner accounts (email, HR portal and VPN) are created before the joining date if HR submits the request at least 5 working days before joining. Otherwise, accounts are created within 2 working days after joining.
- 3.2 Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for every account.
- 3.3 Passwords must have at least 14 characters, must be changed every 180 days, and must not reuse any of the last 5 passwords.
- 3.4 Managers review their team's system access every quarter.

4. Remote Access and VPN

- 4.1 The company VPN, Kestrel Secure Connect, is required to reach any internal system from outside the office network.
- 4.2 VPN access is allowed from any location in India.
- 4.3 Public Wi-Fi may be used only with the VPN switched on.
- 4.4 Access from outside India requires IT Security approval through a service desk ticket in the category "Overseas Access", raised at least 10 working days before travel. Approval is valid only for the dates requested. Access from countries on the sanctioned list maintained by IT Security is not permitted.

5. Service Desk and Troubleshooting

- 5.1 Raise tickets at it.kestrel.example or call extension 4000.
- 5.2 Ticket priorities and response times:

Priority	Meaning	First response time
P1	Security incident, lost device, or office-wide outage	30 minutes
P2	A single user cannot work at all	4 business hours
P3	Service is degraded but the user can still work	1 business day
P4	Service request (new software, access, equipment)	3 business days

- 5.3 If the VPN keeps disconnecting, complete these self-help steps in order:

- Step 1: Update Kestrel Secure Connect to the latest version from Software Centre.
- Step 2: Switch to a different network, or restart your home router.
- Step 3: Reset the VPN profile from Settings > Reset profile, then sign in again.
- If the problem continues, raise a P3 ticket and attach the log file (Help > Export logs).

5.4 For a slow laptop, restart the device and install pending updates. If it is still slow, raise a P3 ticket.

6. Equipment During Internal Transfer

6.1 The company laptop moves with the employee. The employee is responsible for carrying it, in cabin baggage when flying.

6.2 Peripherals are not moved between offices. Request peripherals at the new office by raising a ticket in the category "Desk Setup" at least 10 working days before the first day at the new location.

6.3 Facilities issues the access card for the new office on the first day there. The old access card must be surrendered at the same time.

7. Lost or Stolen Devices

7.1 Report a lost or stolen device to IT Security within 24 hours by raising a P1 ticket, and file a police complaint. Attach a copy of the complaint to the ticket.

7.2 IT Security remotely wipes the lost device.

7.3 If the loss is caused by negligence, such as leaving the device unattended in a public place, the employee pays 25% of the device's current book value.

8. Exit

8.1 On the last working day, the employee returns the laptop, access card and any peripherals issued for home use.

8.2 All accounts are disabled at 18:00 IST on the last working day.

8.3 IT sends an asset clearance certificate to Finance within 2 working days of the assets being returned. Unreturned assets delay the full and final settlement.

9. Data Protection and AI Tools

9.1 Data is classified as Public, Internal, Confidential or Restricted. Customer data is Confidential at minimum.

9.2 Confidential and Restricted data must not be stored on personal devices or personal cloud storage.

9.3 Only approved AI tools, Kestrel Copilot and the company ChatGPT Enterprise workspace, may be used with Internal or Confidential data. Confidential and Restricted data must never be entered into public or free AI tools. Restricted data must not be entered into any AI tool without approval from the Data Protection Officer.

9.4 Report any suspected data leak immediately as a P1 ticket.